

EVIDENCE • LEDGER • STRUCTURE

kpi

Executive KPI system — one base, five layout modifiers.

# Four tiles the eye sweeps in one pass.

4

tiles per row

THE CEILING **ON PLAN**



8

words per tile

SOFT BUDGET **BOARD**

5S

scan time

THE TARGET **ON PLAN**

0

prose sentences

ALLOWED HERE **AUDIT**

# attention flags the tile that misses.

1

tile flagged

THE MISSATTENTION

3

tiles steady

FOR CONTEXTON PLAN

0

alarms hidden

HONESTYBOARD

4

tiles total

THE ROWON PLAN

KPI OPS

# ops reads the tiles against SLOs.

99.9%

the SLO frame

TARGET LINE **SLO**

4

tiles per row

UNCHANGED **ON PLAN**

1

breach shown

NEVER HIDDEN **OPS**

30d

the window

ROLLING **SLO**

KPI COMPLIANCE

# compliance tallies findings per framework.

0

open findings

THE GOAL **CLEAN**

4

frameworks tracked

ONE ROW **AUDIT**

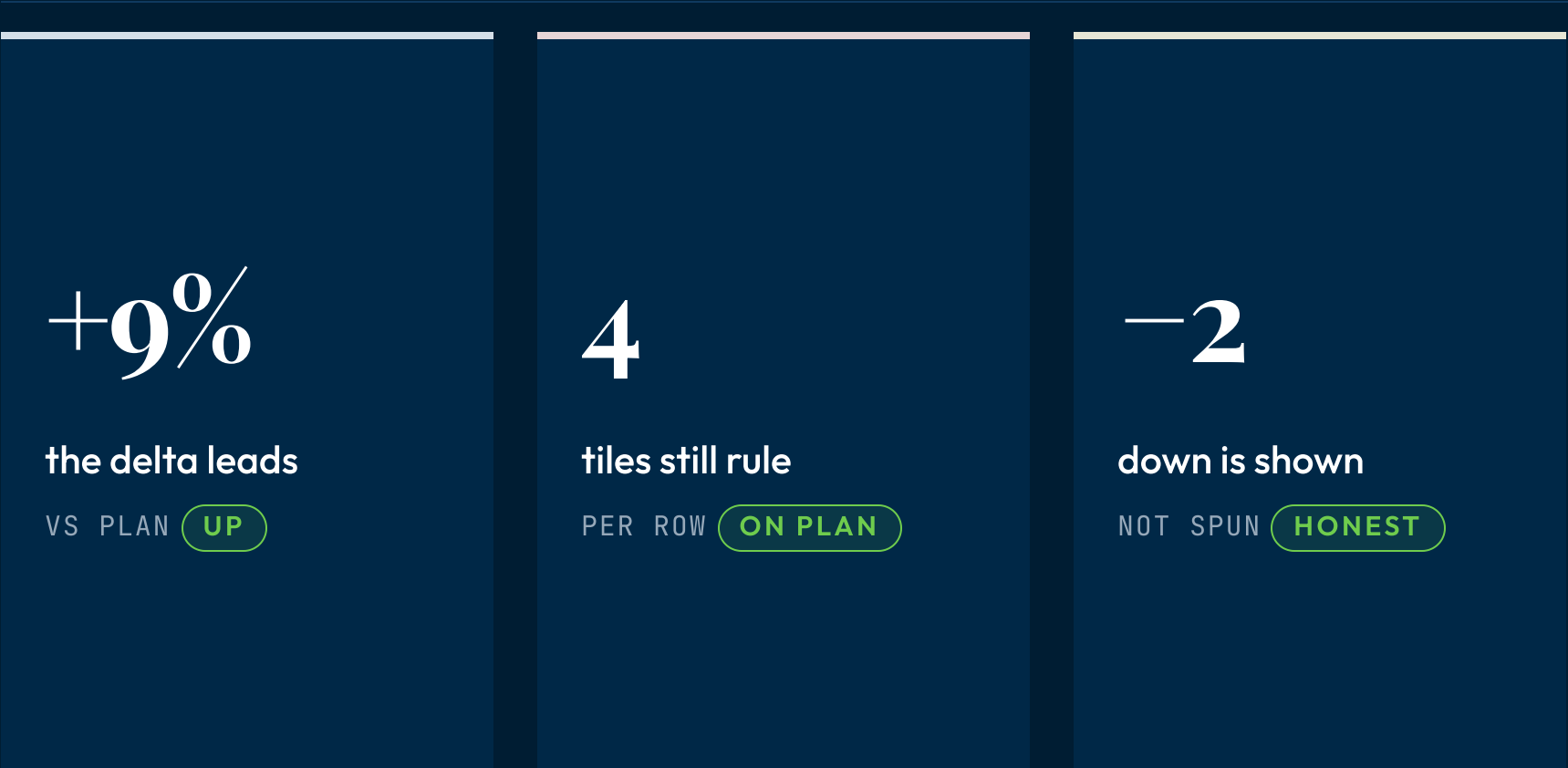
1

in remediation

DATED **WATCH**

KPI TRAJECTORY

trajectory pairs each tile with its delta.



# spotlight gives one tile double width.

1

tile promoted

*the headline* SPOTLIGHT

2

support tiles

BESIDE IT ON PLAN

0

competing heroes

ONE ONLY RULE

# Four tiles at full word weight.

4

the grid's seat count

A FIFTH NEVER RENDERS

MAX

14

words per tile, the budget

SPENDS THE ALLOWANCE

BUDGET

1

line per label

WRAPPING ENDS THE SCAN

RULE

2

slides beat one crowd

SPLIT PAST THIS

ADVICE



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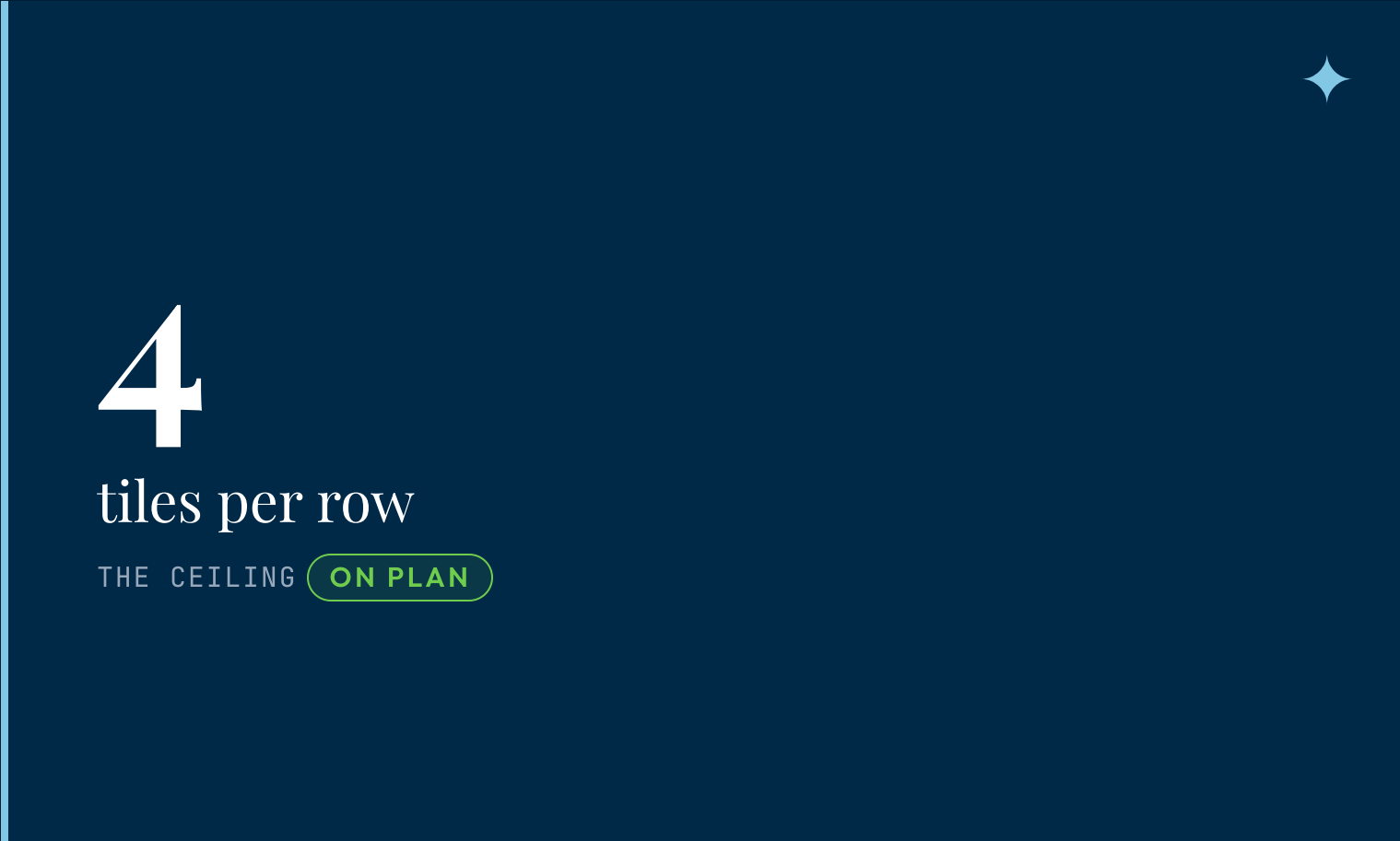
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# When NOT to reach for kpi.

## Decorative pills without status semantics

The pills read as status, not freeform tags. Status color is assigned by each KPI's row position within the modifier — the engine never reads the pill text — so reserve them for the status vocabulary the position implies ( `On plan`, `At risk`, `Breaching`, `Compliant`, `Remediating` ).

## A fifth metric — or a fourth that is not terse

The supports divide whatever the title and eyebrow leave them, so count trades against label length. Measured at a **wide** @size — the box a deck is authored in, and the one where nothing paginates past the budget: three is the allowance, and a short label plus a target line fits up to

## Reaching for attention or spotlight to carry a fifth metric

`attention` highlights the metric that needs the room; `spotlight` monumentalizes one number. Both spend most of the stage on a single tile, so past four the hierarchy they exist to create collapses — split into two slides rather than crowding the hero.

## No targets, no trends

If the KPIs carry only current values, the slide is a stats row, not a kpi dashboard. Use stats and reclaim the room.

## RELATED COMPONENTS

# See also.

`stats` — metric row without targets or status pills

`big-number` — a single number is the whole argument

`split-panel` — one KPI with a paragraph of supporting prose

`progress` — completion percentages across parallel  
workstreams

`timeline-list` — milestones in time, not metrics at a moment